



BIOM1051

Module 1: Principles of Cell Function

Lecture 3

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Module 1: Principles of Cell Function

- Membrane Structure & Function – Lecture 1 & 2
- Cell Communication & Receptor Families – Lecture 3
- Review & Application – Workshop 2
- + the Osmosis Practical

Cell Communication & Receptor Families: Learning Objectives – Lectures 3

- Describe the types of cell to cell communication
- List and describe in general terms the 3 stages of cell signalling
- Briefly compare and contrast the 4 families of receptors
- Explain the concept of signal amplification
- Describe how G protein-coupled receptors produce a response in a cell
- Rationalise the effects of insulin and steroids at the receptor and cellular level

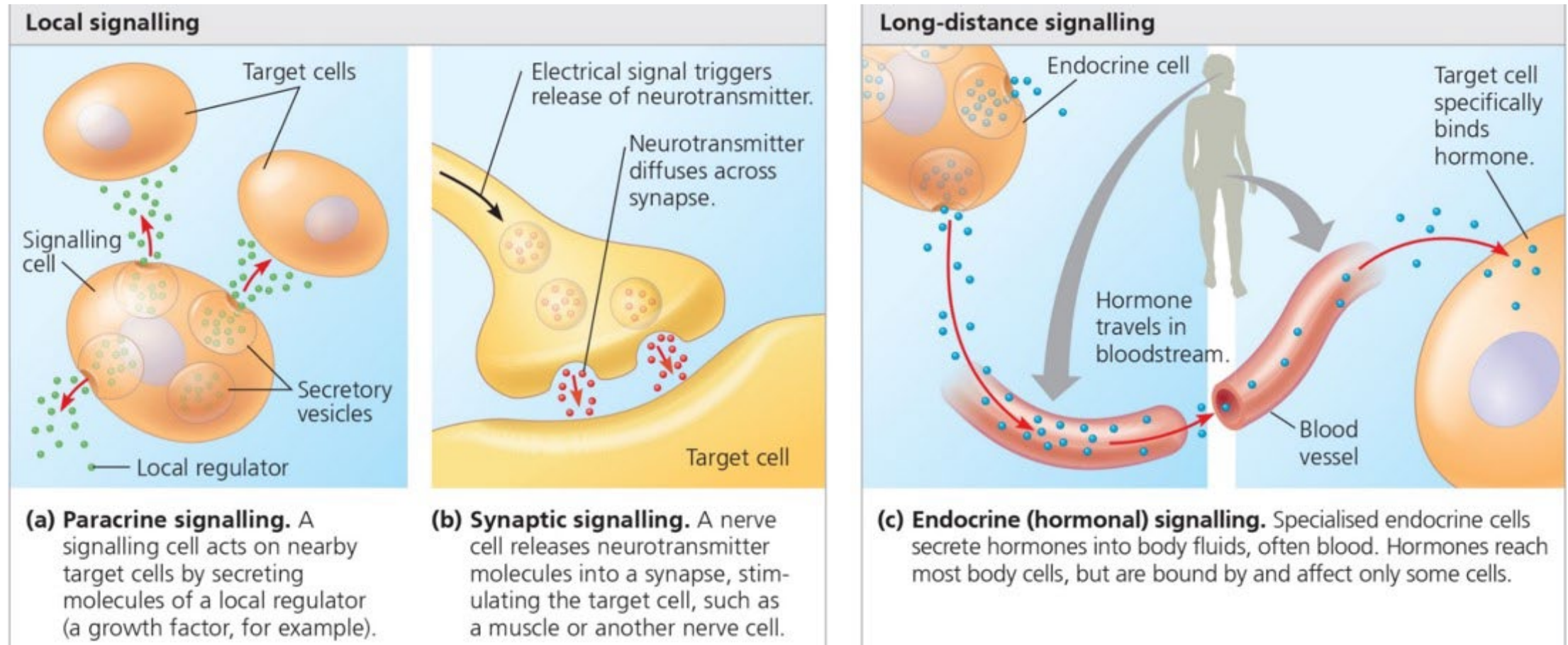
Cell Communication & Receptor Families: Resources

- Campbell Biology, 12th ed, 2021 – Chapter 11
 - Concept 11.1: External signals are converted to responses within the cell
 - Concept 11.2: Reception: A signalling molecule binds to a receptor protein, causing it to change shape
 - Concept 11.3: Transduction: Cascades of molecular interactions relay signals from receptors to target molecules in the cell
 - Concept 11.4: Response: Cell signalling leads to regulation of transcription or cytoplasmic activities
- GPCR Mechanism Video: Blackboard
- Mastering Biology

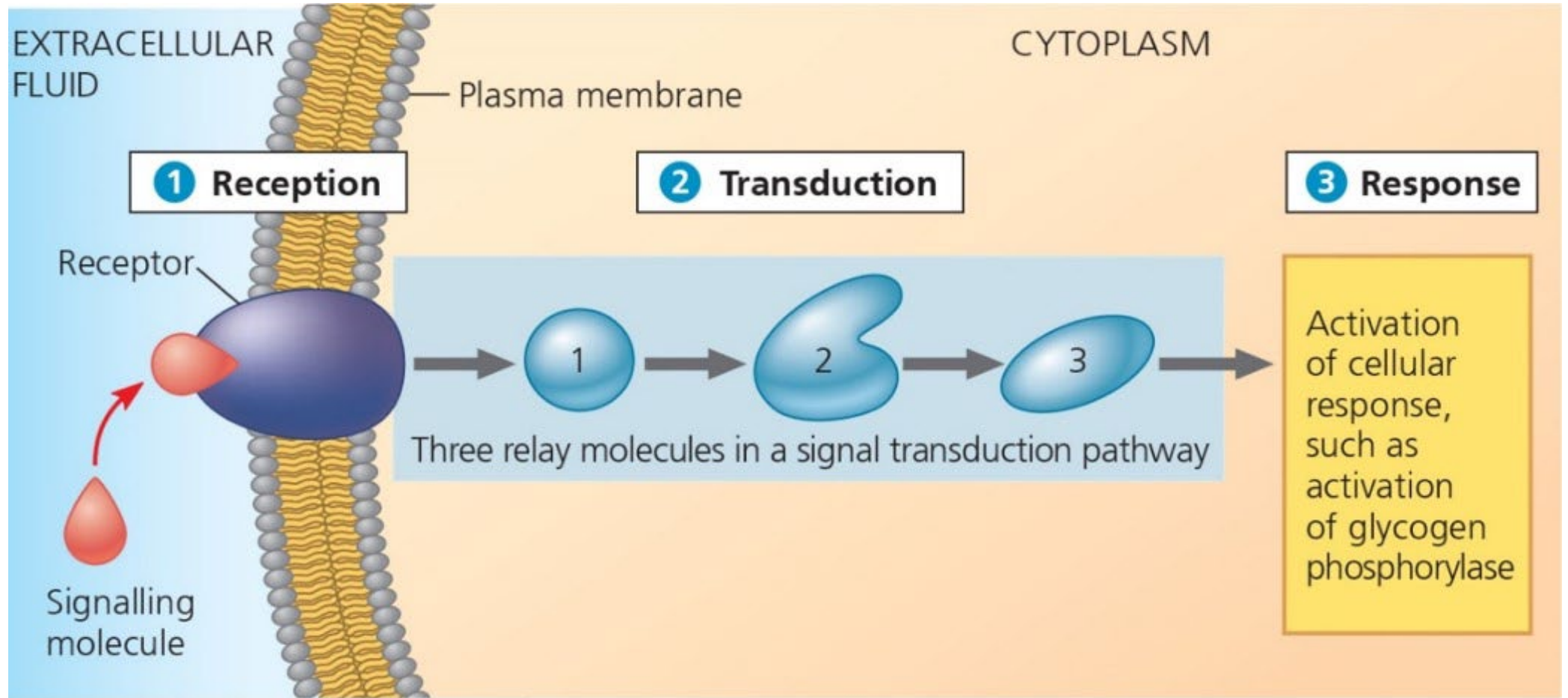
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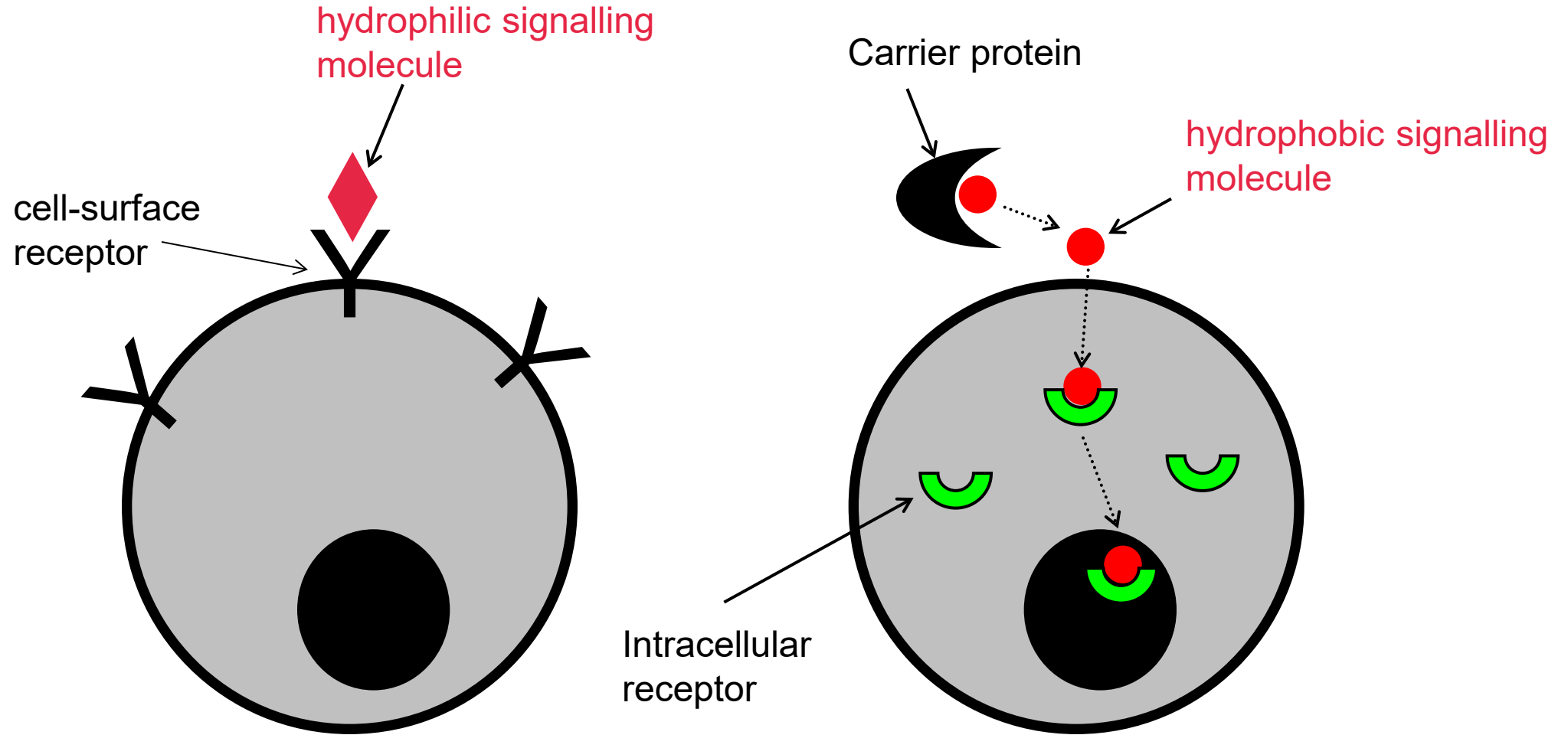
Cell to cell communication: Local vs. long-distance signalling



Cell to cell communication: 3 stages of cell signalling



Hormone/Ligand/Agonist act via receptors



Response – e.g. gene activation, enzyme stimulation, rearrange cytoskeleton

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Receptor Families

Plasma Membrane Receptors

- ❖ Ion channel receptors:
 - Na^+ channel opened by ligand – e.g. nicotinic receptors for acetylcholine – fast neurotransmission
- ❖ G protein-coupled receptors: 7 TM-spanning regions
 - all aspects of physiology and pharmacology
- ❖ Receptor tyrosine kinases: e.g. insulin receptors
 - metabolism, cell growth, cell reproduction

Intracellular receptors

- ❖ Steroid receptors

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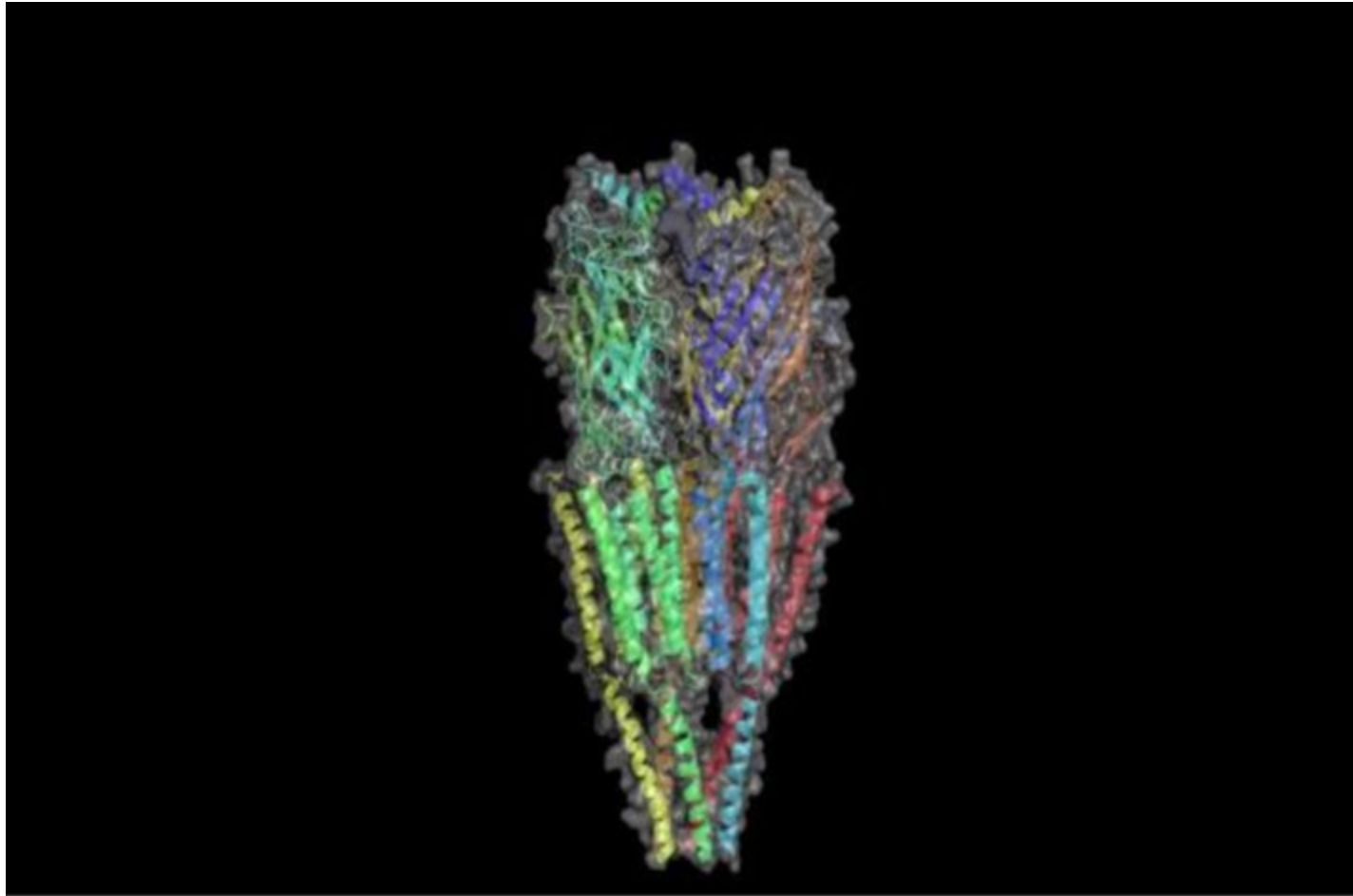
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Intracellular receptors

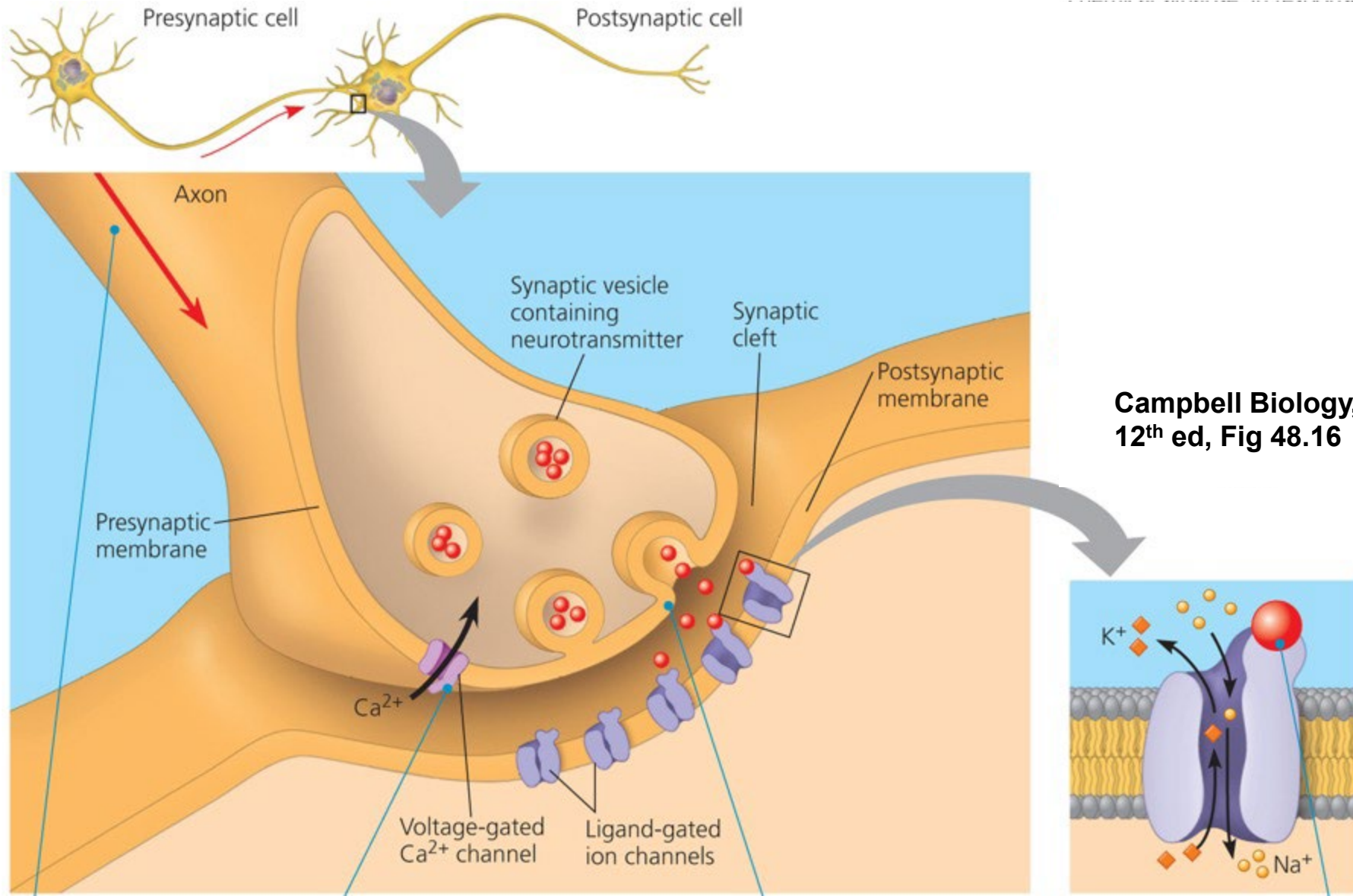
- ❖ Steroid receptors

Ion channel receptors

- ligand-gated ion channel
- e.g. nicotinic acetylcholine receptor



Ion channel linked receptors = Ligand-gated ion channels



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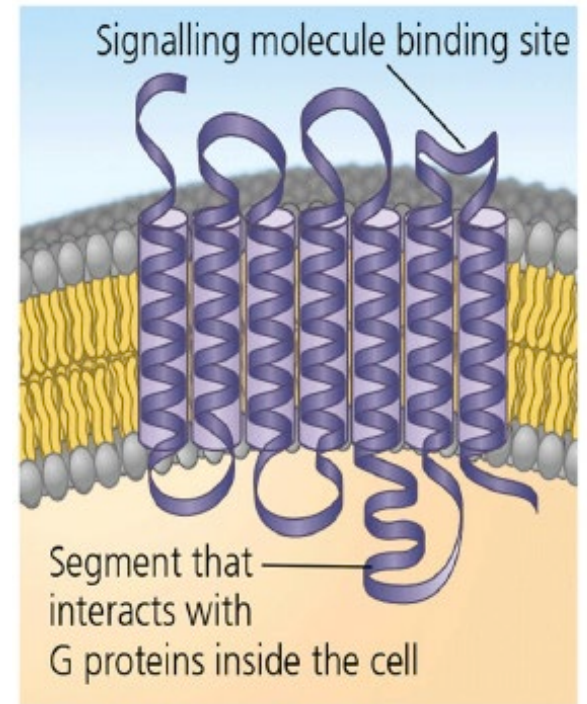
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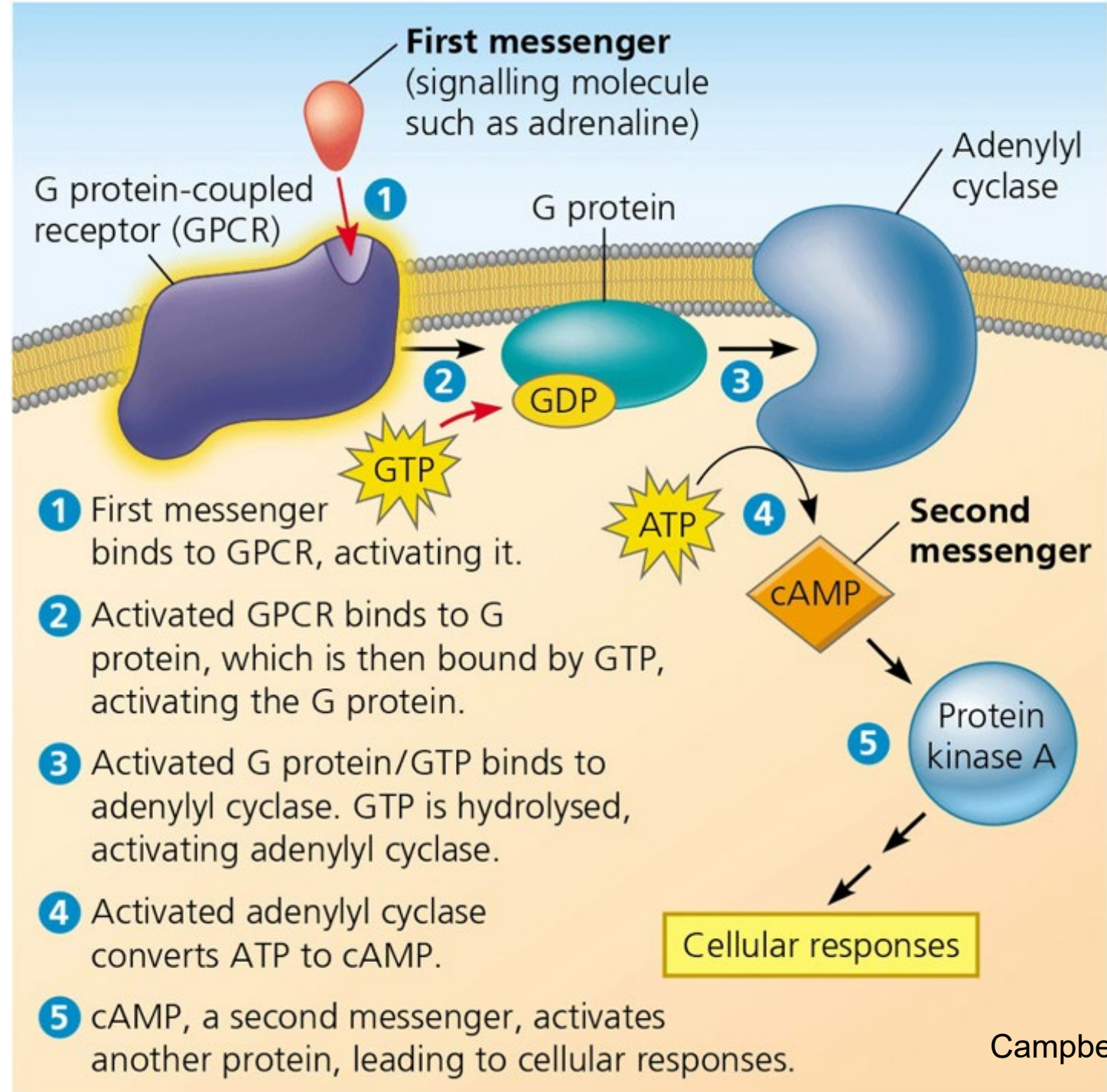
G protein-coupled receptors (GPCRs)

- seven transmembrane spanning domains (7 TMDs)
- the largest family of receptors:
 - >1000 members in human genome
 - 150 orphans
 - >50% of current drugs target GPCRs
- activated by a variety of stimuli:
 - light, ions (eg. Ca^{2+}), odourants, gustative molecules, neurotransmitters, hormones, peptides, proteins.
- GPCRs interact with heterotrimeric G proteins to control the activity of enzymes, ion channels, and intracellular signal transduction pathways

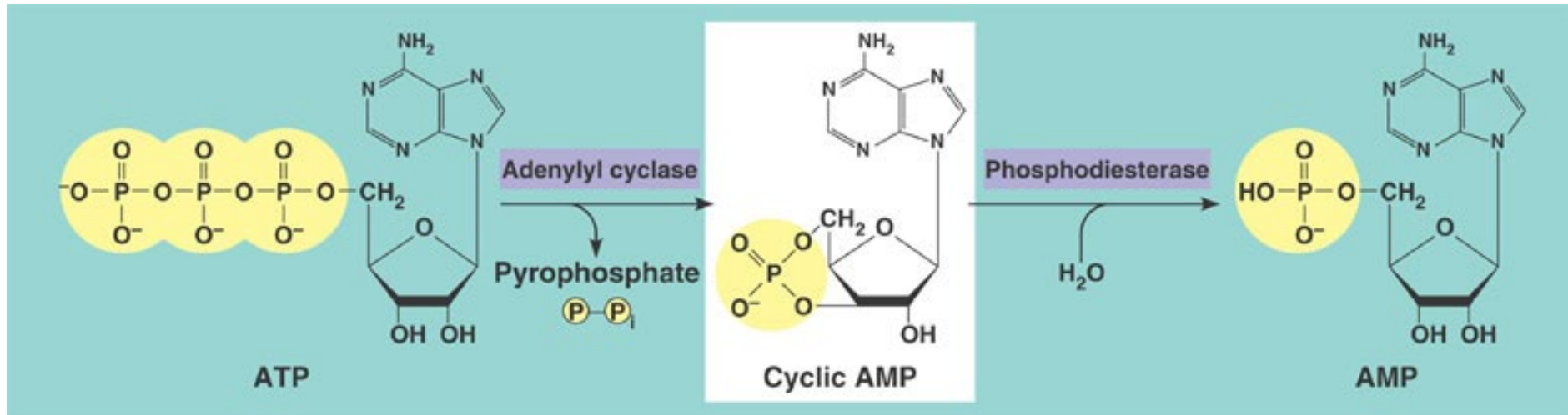


G protein-coupled receptor

Campbell Biology, 12th ed, Fig. 11.8

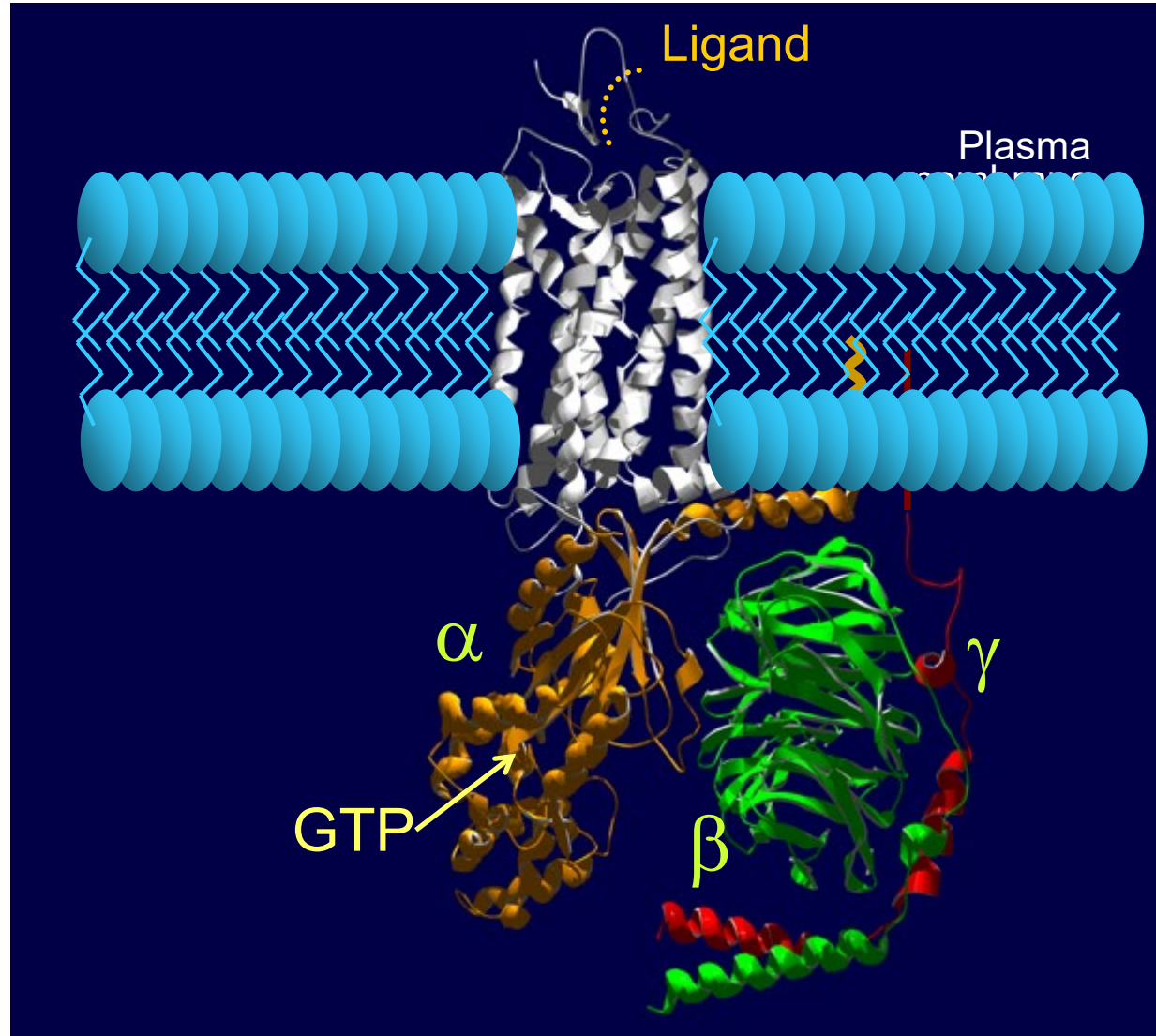
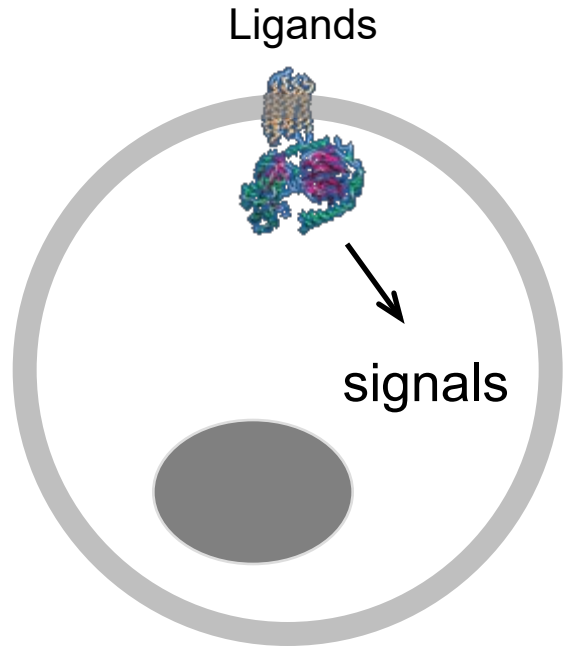


Adenylyl cyclase turns ATP into cyclic AMP

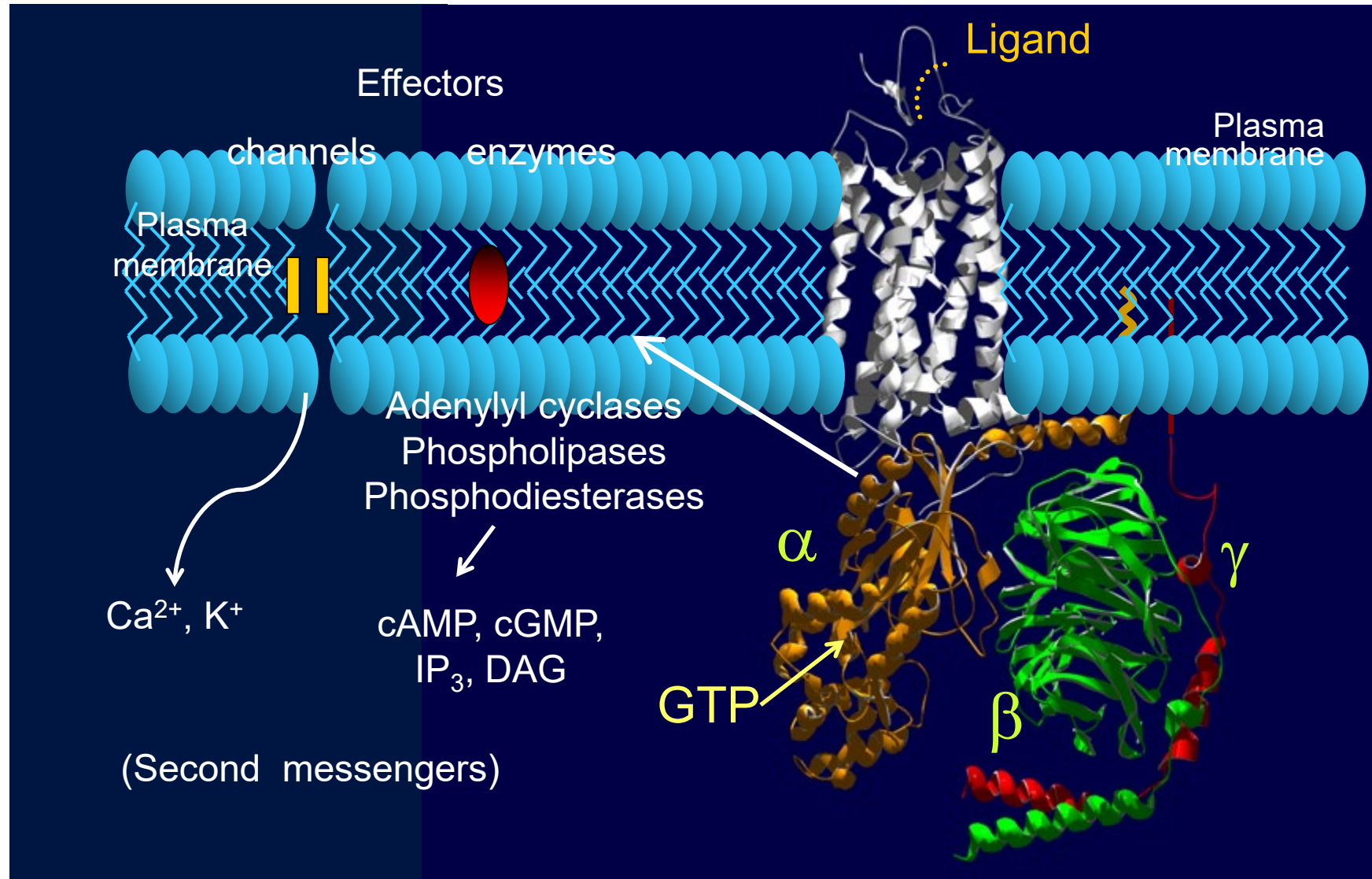


ATP – adenosine triphosphate is also important as a source of cellular energy!!

G protein-coupled receptors (GPCRs)



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G-Protein Coupled Receptor (GPCR) ▾



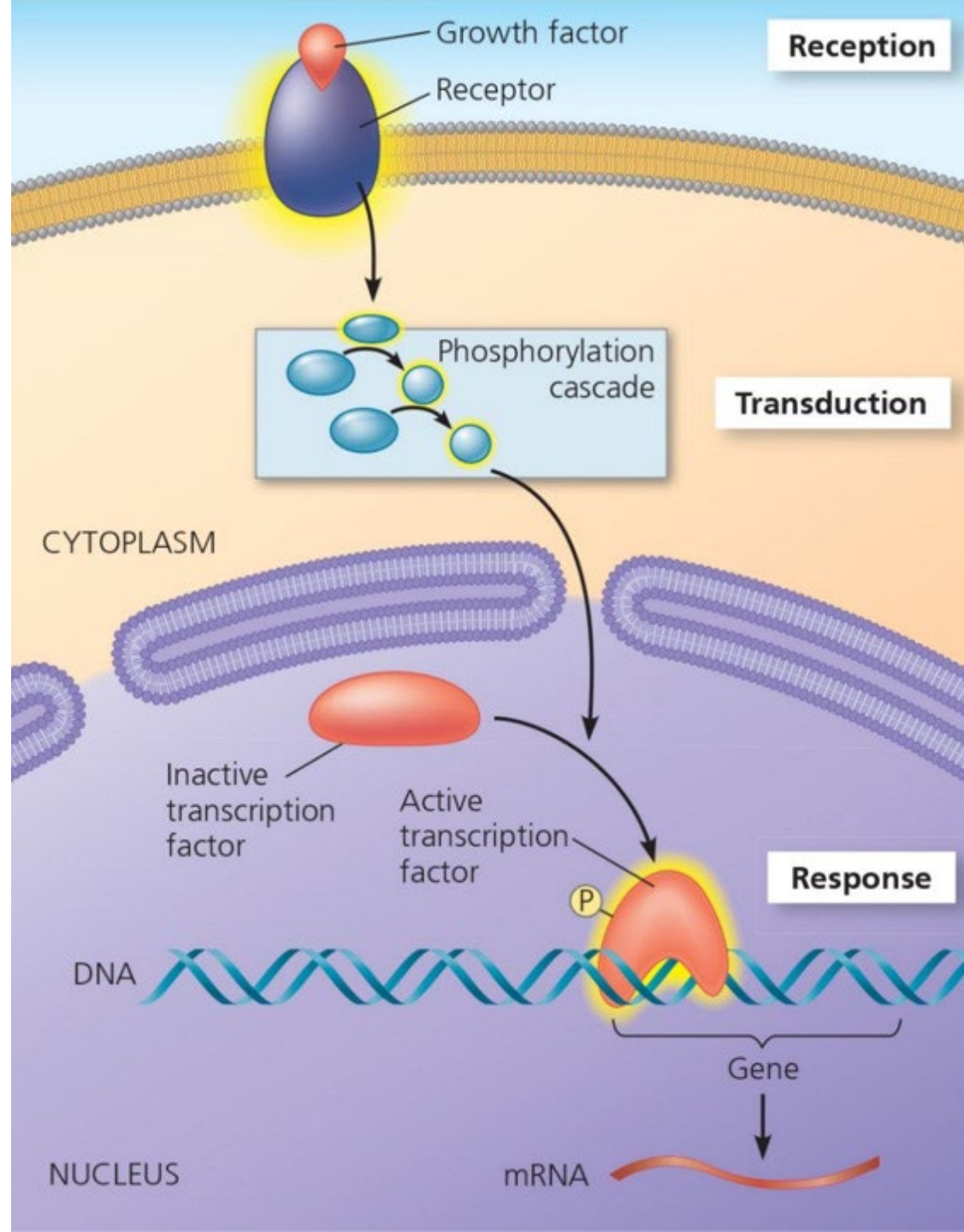
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Intracellular receptors

- ❖ Steroid receptors

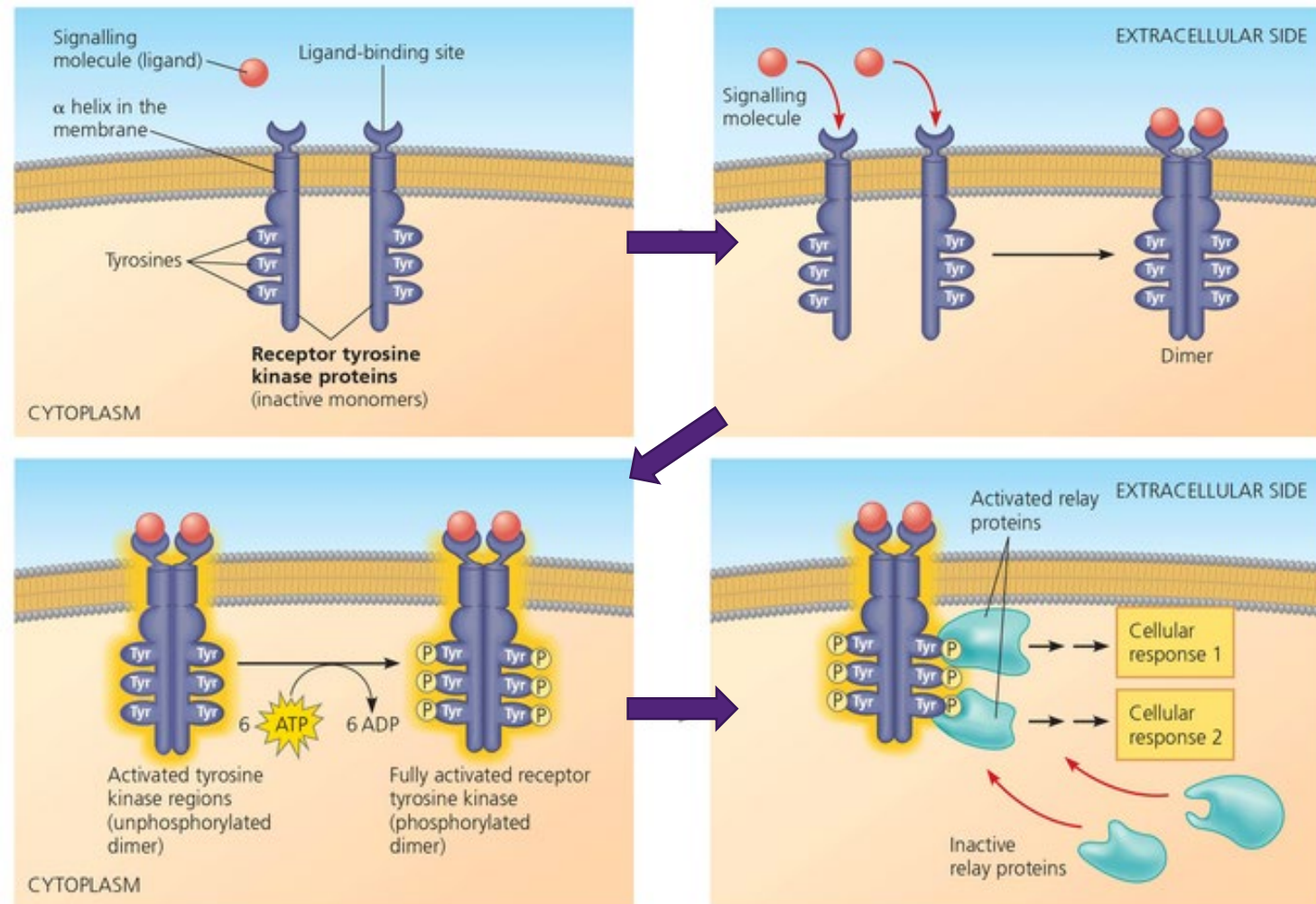


Phosphorylation Cascades...

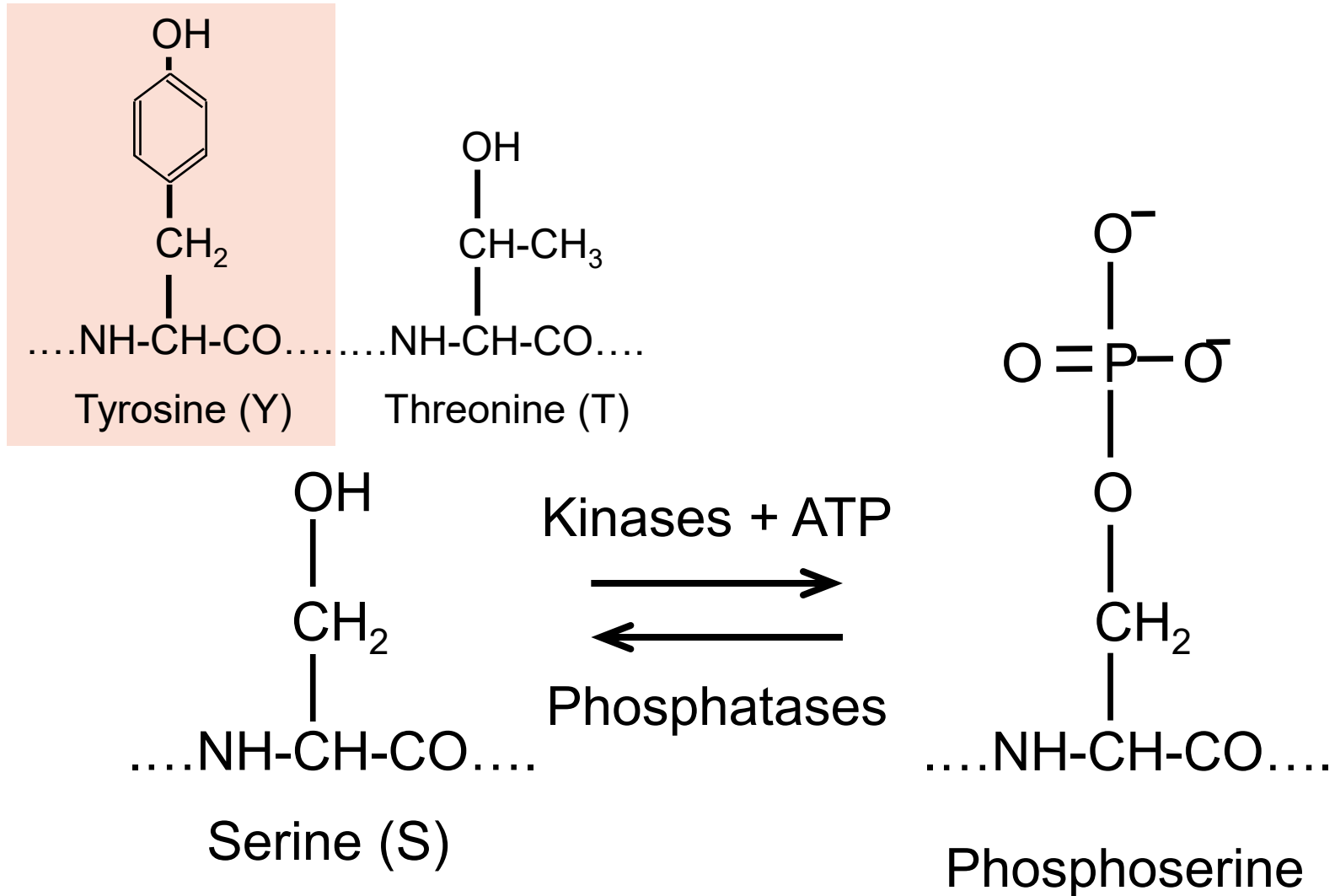
Mediated by enzymes called KINASES – these transfer phosphate and activate or inactivate target proteins

Phosphate = PO_4^-

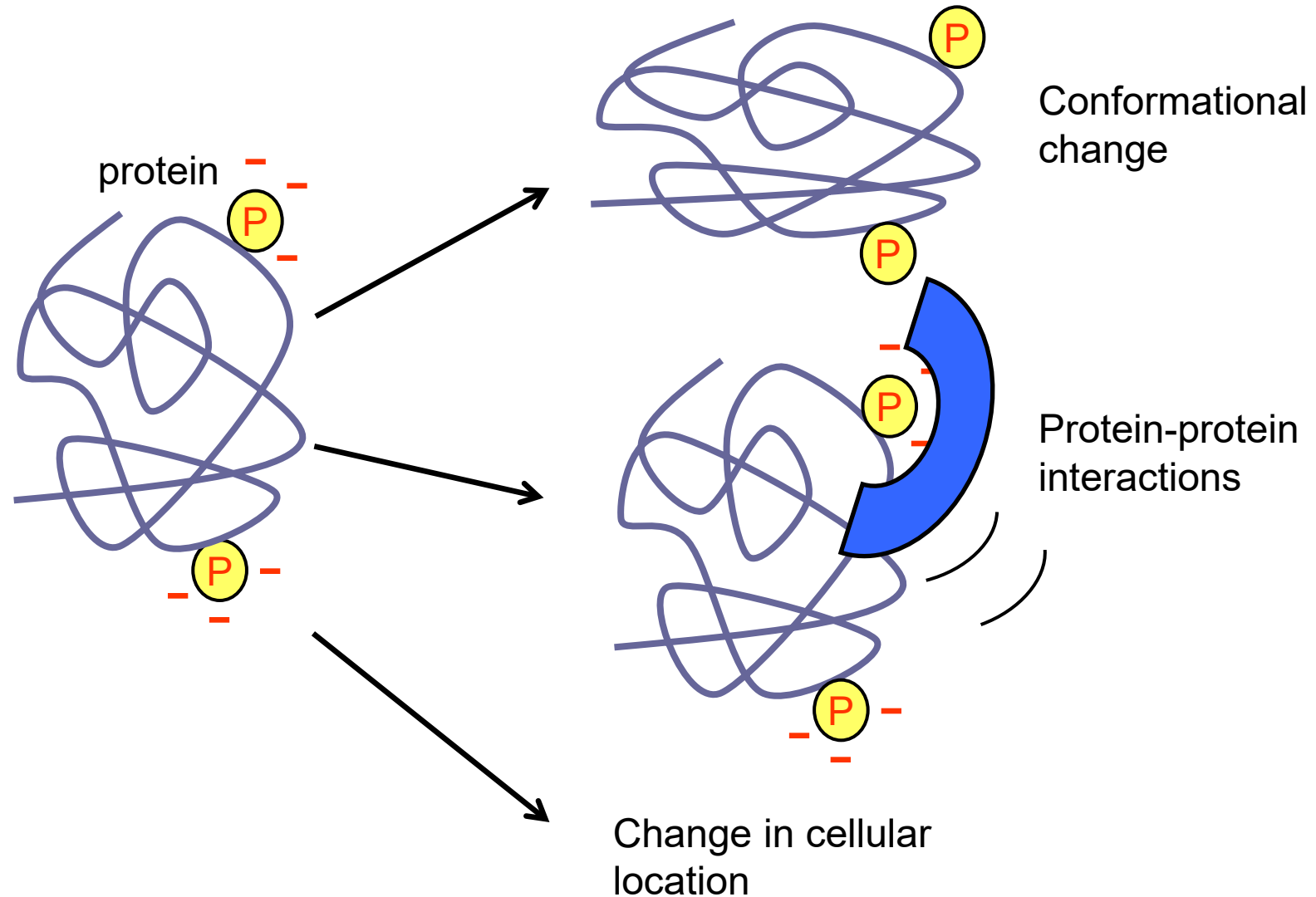
Receptor tyrosine kinases (RTKs)



Protein phosphorylation



Role of protein phosphorylation



These changes lead to activation or inactivation of the target proteins!

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Steroid hormone interacting with an intracellular steroid receptor

